

Figure 4: P. Pandithurai Thevar

B. Venkataramanujulu Naidu, president of South India Bank, Tirunelveli and proprietor of a Swadeshi store, Tuticorin, invested Rs 10,000 in SSNCo and joined the board of directors. According to a police assessment, he was ‘a keen swadeshi but not known to be seditious.’ Cited as a defence witness in the sedition case against VOC, he was not however put in the dock. The police speculated that he had lent the money that Pandithurai Thevar had invested.[57]

S.S.V. Krishna Pillai, A.M.M. Arunachalam Pillai and S.T.A. Arumugam Pillai were strong backers of VOC. Little more is known of them except that VOC named his second son after S.T.A. Arumugam Pillai in gratitude.